MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DEVOPS / PLATFORM ENGINEERING | CI/CD & TEST INFRASTRUCTURE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA Automation Engineer with 7 years of experience and a strong focus on CI/CD pipelines, test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral test environments used by three product teams. Experienced in improving pipeline performance and reliability, deploying Helm charts to shared Kubernetes environments, and building a personal k3s GitOps lab. Currently preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and Containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure as Code and Configuration: Terraform (personal projects), Ansible (basic)
Kubernetes and Delivery: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments to a shared cluster), Helm, k3s, Argo CD
Monitoring and Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming and Testing: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner cost decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments (application, PostgreSQL and seeded data) using Docker Compose and later Helm charts on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python, PostgreSQL and Grafana dashboard to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored an internal guide to CI used in team onboarding.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Created a GitLab CI workflow that deploys a separate short-lived environment for each merge request, including the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data.
- Enabled QA and product reviewers to assess features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against each environment.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, introduced dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Preparing for Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA); exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)